

The headline

On **5 May 2026**, Anthropic launched Claude for Financial Services:

- **10 ready-to-run agent templates** for high-volume FS workflows
- **Microsoft 365 integration** — Excel, PowerPoint, Word, Outlook
- **MCP-based connectors** to ~11 financial data providers (Daloopa, S&P, Moody’s, FactSet, LSEG, PitchBook, ...)
- **Enterprise controls** — SSO (SAML/OIDC), SCIM, audit logs, ISO/IEC 42001:2023

Underlying model: **Claude Opus 4.7**. Benchmark: **64.37%** on Vals AI Finance Agent (finance-specific eval, current best-in-class).

The 10 agents

Research & Client Coverage	Finance & Operations
Pitch Builder — target lists, comps, pitchbooks	Valuation Reviewer — vs comparables & firm standards
Meeting Preparer — client/counterparty briefs	GL Reconciler — reconciliation & NAV
Earnings Reviewer — transcripts → model updates	Month-End Closer — close checklist + reports
Model Builder — models from filings + feeds	Statement Auditor — consistency & audit-readiness
Market Researcher — sector/issuer intel	KYC Screener — entity files + escalations

Each template is a bundle of three layers: markdown **skills** (how a senior banker does this), **MCP connectors** (scoped data access), and addressable **subagents**. Inspectable, not a black box.

How it ships — three access paths

Path	What you get	Requires
A. M365 + Cowork	Claude inside Excel/PPT/Word/Outlook + the 10 FS agents	Claude Team / Enterprise + M365 admin install
B. Claude Code	Agents from terminal / scripted context	Claude Code subscription
C. Managed Agents	Programmatic, autonomous, behind your workflow engine	Anthropic API access (org) + engineering

Path A note: the M365 add-in can be deployed against your firm’s own cloud (Vertex AI, Bedrock, internal LLM gateway) via the `claude-for-msft-365-install` Claude Code plugin — traffic then stays in your cloud, compliance posture is whatever you already have for that cloud.

Where we stand

Have	Don’t have
✓ Microsoft 365 Copilot	✗ Claude.ai (consumer)
✓ GitHub Copilot	✗ Claude Team / Enterprise
	✗ Claude for M365 (Excel/PPT/Word/Outlook plugin)
	✗ Claude Cowork
	✗ Claude Code
	✗ Anthropic API (org-level)

No path from M365 Copilot or GitHub Copilot to the Claude FS agents. The two product families are entirely separate.

What to tell colleagues

“Yes — Anthropic launched Claude for Financial Services in May. It’s a strong product for our type of work, but we don’t have a sanctioned channel to use it: our office AI tooling today is Microsoft 365 Copilot and GitHub Copilot, and Claude requires a separate subscription we haven’t acquired.”

If they push — “can I just use my personal account?”:

“Not on office data, no — that would be a data-handling issue regardless of how useful the output is. Personal Claude is fine for personal exploration; office work goes through office-sanctioned tools.”

Personal accounts — the boundary

A personal Claude subscription is **not** a sanctioned channel for office work. No DPA with our firm; no audit logging into our compliance posture; default Anthropic retention (not enterprise zero-retention). **Personal Claude is for personal exploration. Office work goes through office-sanctioned tools.** True regardless of how useful the output looks.

FAQ

Q. So can we get it? A: That’s a procurement & compliance conversation, not this one. Worth raising with whoever owns AI tooling decisions.

Q. Isn’t M365 Copilot enough? A: For a large slice, yes. Where it isn’t: multi-doc synthesis, citation discipline, FS-specific connectors. Whether that gap matters is the procurement conversation.

Q. Isn’t this just the same model with a coat of paint? A: Partly fair. Underlying model is Claude Opus 4.7 (same as raw API). What’s added: bundled FS templates, FS data connectors, M365 plugins, enterprise controls. Four things not trivial to assemble yourself.

Q. Personal accounts on personal time? A: Personal data, personal projects — fine. Office data through office tooling. Same rule as any external AI service.

Q. Should we switch to Claude for Excel? A: On the FMW benchmark, Claude leads at 83%. But that’s a snapshot; Copilot is improving. “Should we switch” is the procurement conversation. Today we use what we have.

Q. Can we run the demo template on our data? A: No. Public data only, in a personal Cowork instance, for demonstration. European banks, Microsoft, Apple — fine. Office data — not appropriate.

Q. Couldn’t we just clone the GitHub repo and self-host? A: The repo is Apache 2.0, but the orchestrator is Claude itself, which only runs via paid Anthropic surfaces (or BYOC on Vertex/Bedrock). Plus: data connectors require paid data subscriptions; templates are generic (firm-specific tuning is the 80%). Free to read; not free to run.

Q. Big Four — Deloitte, PwC, KPMG, EY? A: All four announced internal Claude rollouts: PwC and KPMG in mid-May, Deloitte in late 2025, EY in late-May. Whether they’re packaging FS consulting around it externally is less clear — partnership conversation, not a tooling one.

Q. Isn’t sending Excel data to an external AI service the dealbreaker? A: Out of the box, that’s where traffic goes. But the M365 add-in can be deployed via the `claude-for-msft-365-install` plugin against your firm’s own cloud (Vertex / Bedrock / internal gateway). Data path becomes Excel → your cloud → Claude on your cloud → back.

Q. I think we should buy it. A: Good. Right venue is whoever owns AI tooling decisions here. This pack is the briefing they’ll need.

Further reading

The team folder

- 01-what-it-is.md — the offering in detail
- 02-how-it-ships.md — subscription tiers, deployment paths, BYOC routing
- 03-our-access-situation.md — the honest articulation of where we stand
- 04-what-we-can-do-today.md — pragmatic guidance with M365 + GitHub Copilot
- demos/01-sector-overview.md — prompt template to run the Market Researcher agent on a public sector (e.g. European banks) in personal Cowork
- appendix-sources.md — every claim, sourced; videos; what we did NOT verify

Videos (May 2026 launch)

- The Briefing: Financial Services** (Anthropic event, 5 May 2026, 1.5h) — the launch event itself.
anthropic.com/events/the-briefing-financial-services-virtual-event
- Claude for FS: Putting agents to work** (webinar, 7 May 2026, with demos).
anthropic.com/webinars/claude-for-financial-services-putting-agents-to-work
- Claude for FS teams — on-demand recording** (59 min, Nick Lynn + Owen Scully) — best single resource.
anthropic.ondemand.goldcast.io/on-demand/74ae0fc7-f591-442f-8fe1-244f409c1fb5

Open-source repo (Apache 2.0)

- github.com/anthropics/financial-services — skills, agents, MCP connectors, the `claude-for-msft-365-install` BYOC plugin. Free to read; running anything still requires paid Anthropic surfaces or BYOC on Vertex / Bedrock.